

THE SELLER GUIDE

5 questions every seller should ask *before they list.*

A short field guide for Greater Boston homeowners weighing their options. The questions inside are the ones that change the math, your timeline, and what you actually walk away with.

BEFORE YOU START

Most sellers only ever hear *one path*.

You can list on the open market. You can take a cash offer. You can wait six months. You can sell to an investor through a private network. You can do a pre-listing renovation, a light cosmetic refresh, or sell as is. Each of those has a different number attached to it. Each of those has a different timeline and a different level of risk.

Most agents lead with "list with me." This guide leads with the math, because the right answer for you is not always the answer that pays the agent the most.

Work through these five questions before you commit to a path. They are the ones I walk every seller through on my strategy session, and they are the questions the data side of selling actually depends on.

How to use this guide

Read all five. Sit with the ones that surprise you. Bring the answers, or the questions you cannot answer, to whoever you trust to help you decide. Or bring them to me on a 30 minute strategy session. There is no commitment to list.

01

QUESTION ONE • THE NET COMPARISON

What would my home realistically net if I listed it on the open market versus accepted a *cash offer* in today's Greater Boston market?

WHY IT MATTERS

Most sellers anchor to a list price they saw on a competitor's home and never actually do the net math. The number that matters is what hits your bank account after commissions, concessions, holding costs, repairs, staging, and your eventual closing costs, side by side against the all-in net of a cash offer with none of those line items.

Two homes can list for the same price and net the seller wildly different amounts. The list price is a starting point. The net is the answer.

WATCH OUT FOR

"It will probably sell for around X" is not a net. Ask for the full sheet, both paths, every line item.

02

QUESTION TWO · THE COST OF GETTING READY

How much would I need to spend on repairs, clean-out, or updates before listing, and would I actually *get that money back* at closing?

WHY IT MATTERS

The temptation is to spend money on a home so it shows better. Sometimes that returns more than it costs. Often it does not. Painting, decluttering, and a deep clean almost always pay for themselves. Kitchen renovations, bathroom remodels, and roof replacements rarely return dollar for dollar at the closing table.

The real comparison is what your home would net in current condition against what it would net after a specific spend, with the cost and the carrying time honestly factored in. Sometimes the math points to as is. Sometimes a targeted spend genuinely unlocks more.

WATCH OUT FOR

*A long list of recommended improvements without a return on each.
Every line should have a number attached.*

03

QUESTION THREE · THE COST OF TIME

How fast do I truly need to sell, and what is that timeline *worth to me* in dollars?

WHY IT MATTERS

Every month a home sits on the market, it is costing you something. Sometimes a real number, the mortgage, the insurance, the taxes, the utilities. Sometimes a softer cost, the stress of an empty house, the delay on a relocation, the strain of carrying two payments.

A cash offer that nets less on paper can net more in reality once you factor in three months of carrying costs you would not otherwise pay. The right question is not "which number is bigger." The right question is "which number is bigger after I subtract the time."

WATCH OUT FOR

"Days on market" averages that do not reflect your specific neighborhood, price band, or condition.

04

QUESTION FOUR · THE AVOIDABLE MISTAKE

What are the biggest ways Massachusetts sellers in my situation accidentally *leave money on the table* by choosing the wrong path?

WHY IT MATTERS

The most expensive mistakes are not the ones you make at the closing table. They are the ones you make at the start, when you choose a path that does not fit your situation. A tired landlord who lists publicly with tenants in place. An inherited home rushed onto the market before probate is clear. A pre-listing renovation on a home that would have sold for the same number as is.

The path that fits a turn-key home in a popular zip code is not the path that fits an estate sale, a deferred maintenance situation, or a property with title quirks. Sellers in complicated situations need a different conversation entirely.

WATCH OUT FOR

Advice that sounds the same regardless of your situation. The right answer is situation-specific.

05

QUESTION FIVE · THE STRESS TEST

If we stress-test my sale against inspection, appraisal, financing, or title issues, which option gives me the best balance of *net, speed, and certainty?*

WHY IT MATTERS

A great offer on paper can still fall apart. Inspection negotiations, appraisal gaps, buyer financing delays, probate complications, title issues. Each of those is a real risk on the open market path. A cash offer eliminates most of them but usually nets less. The right answer depends on which risks you can absorb and which would genuinely hurt you.

A seller relocating across the country and starting a new job in 45 days has a different tolerance for risk than a seller with no timeline pressure. The same numbers can lead to opposite recommendations once you factor in what each seller can actually afford to have go wrong.

WATCH OUT FOR

Offers presented without a risk discussion. Every path has trade-offs. You deserve to see them.

READY WHEN YOU ARE

Want me to walk you through these *on your* *home?*

Book a free 30 minute strategy session. We work through all five questions on your specific situation. You leave with the numbers, the trade-offs, and a clear recommendation. No commitment to list.

Book my strategy session

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Strategy first. Decisions backed by data.